

The Edge of the World 第一节英语笔记

原文带有英式用法、奇幻词汇和刻意模仿的乡村方言。本笔记把原句与翻译放在一起，只保留最实用的词义和现代说法。

1. Glanders、vermin、alderman、brow

Context: I don't know how to treat glanders. / vermin / alderman / He furrowed his brow.

翻译：我不知道怎么治疗马鼻疽。/ 害虫或有害动物。/ 市议员。/ 他皱起了眉头。

- glanders /'glændəz/：马鼻疽；疾病名，虽以 -s 结尾，但不表示复数。
- vermin：老鼠、害虫等有害生物；也可侮辱性地指坏人。
- alderman：市议员，多见于历史背景或部分英美城市。
- brow：额头、眉部；furrow one's brow：皱起眉头。
- 现代口语：He frowned. / He looked puzzled.
- 现代书面：He furrowed his brow in concentration.

2. Werethings 与发痒的眼皮

Context: werethings / rubbing an itching eyelid with his knuckles

翻译：变形怪。/ 他用指关节揉着发痒的眼皮。

- werething / were-thing：能在人与动物或怪物形态之间变化的奇幻生物；日常解释可说 shapeshifting creature。
- itching eyelid：发痒的眼皮；现代英语更常说 itchy eyelid。
- knuckles：指关节。
- rub A with B：用 B 揉或擦 A。
- 现代口语：He rubbed his itchy eye with his knuckles.

3. Chuckle、impudently、ponder

Context: Dandelion chuckled impudently. The alderman pondered a long while.

翻译：丹德里恩放肆地轻笑了一声。市议员沉思了许久。

- chuckle：轻声笑、低声笑。
- impudently：无礼地、放肆地。
- ponder：认真考虑、沉思，比 think about 更正式。
- 现代口语：He gave a cheeky laugh. He thought about it for a long time.
- 现代书面：The alderman pondered the matter for a long while.

4. 马鬃、多足怪与村民口中的怪物

Context: They tangle up the horses' manes in the stables. Myriapodans! You come up all in spots because of them.

翻译：它们会把马厩里马的鬃毛弄得乱成一团。多足怪！它们会让你浑身起斑点。

Context: The next few minutes passed in a recital of the monsters which plagued the local peasants with their dishonorable doings, or their simple existence.

翻译：接下来几分钟，众人逐一列举了那些以卑劣行径--或仅凭自身的存在--祸害当地农民的怪物。

- tangle up：使缠结、弄乱；mane：马或狮子的鬃毛；stable：马厩。
- myriapodans：多足类怪物；come up in spots：皮肤出现斑点或疹子。
- a recital of...：这里指详细讲述、逐一列举，不是音乐独奏会。
- plague someone：不断困扰或祸害某人；peasants：历史或奇幻背景中的农民。
- dishonorable doings：卑劣勾当，带有夸张、幽默色彩。
- 现代口语：They make you break out in spots. / They listed all the monsters troubling the villagers.
- 现代书面：They recounted the creatures said to plague the local population.

5. Misguids、mamunes、drunken stupor、drake

Context: Geralt and Dandelion learned of misguids and mamunes, which prevent an honest peasant from finding his way home in a drunken stupor, and of the flying drake which drinks milk from cows.

翻译：杰洛特和丹德里恩听说了迷路怪与马穆恩怪；据说它们会让喝得烂醉的老实农民找不到回家的路。他们还听说了会吸食牛奶的飞龙。

- misguids / mamunes：故事中的民间怪物名，具体外形并不重要。
- learn of...：听说、得知。
- prevent someone from doing...：阻止某人做……。
- find one's way home：找到回家的路。
- in a drunken stupor：烂醉得神志不清。这里带有讽刺：农民因醉酒迷路，却怪罪怪物。
- drake：奇幻语境中指龙或龙形生物；日常也可指雄鸭。
- 现代口语：He was too drunk to find his way home.
- 现代书面：The creatures allegedly caused drunken travelers to lose their way.

6. Old Nan、面粉掺假与王室总管

Context: They weren't spared hearing that old Nan the Hag flies on a broom at night and performs abortions in the day; that the miller tampers with the flour by mixing it with powdered acorns; and that a certain Duda believed the royal steward to be a thief and scoundrel.

翻译：他们还不得不听人说：老巫婆南恩夜里骑扫帚飞，白天给人做堕胎手术；磨坊主往面粉里掺橡子粉；而某个叫杜达的人认为王室总管是个小偷和恶棍。

- They weren't spared hearing...：他们没能免于听到……；自然说法是“他们还不得不听……”。
- hag：老巫婆、丑陋老妇；perform an abortion：实施堕胎手术。
- miller：磨坊主；tamper with...：对……做手脚。
- powdered acorns：橡子粉。
- believe someone to be...：认为某人是……。
- royal steward：王室总管；scoundrel：无赖、恶棍。
- 现代口语：They also had to listen to stories about old Nan.
- 现代书面：The miller was accused of adulterating the flour with powdered acorns.

7. Feigned interest 与 yapping dogs

Context: Geralt listened calmly, nodding with feigned interest. They rode away accompanied by yapping dogs and screaming children.

翻译：杰洛特平静地听着，装出感兴趣的样子点头。他们骑马离开，身边伴随着狗的尖叫声和孩子们的喊声。

- feigned interest：假装出来的兴趣。
- nod with feigned interest：装作感兴趣地点头。
- yap：狗短促、尖锐而烦人地叫；yapping dogs：不停尖声叫的狗。
- accompanied by...：伴随着……。
- 现代口语：He nodded and pretended to be interested. / The dogs wouldn't stop yapping.
- 现代书面：They departed amid the yapping of dogs and the cries of children.

8. 踩着马镫摘苹果

Context: Dandelion, standing in the stirrups, picked a fine apple from a branch which stretched over the orchard fence.

翻译：丹德里恩踩着马镫站起身，从一根伸出果园围栏的树枝上摘下一个好苹果。

- stand in the stirrups：踩着马镫站起身；stirrups 通常用复数。
- pick an apple from...：从……摘下苹果。
- stretch over...：延伸到……上方；orchard：果园。
- 现代口语：He stood up in the stirrups and picked an apple from an overhanging branch.
- 现代书面：Rising in the stirrups, he plucked an apple from a branch extending over the fence.

9. 创作歌谣与扔苹果核

Context: I'd have some beautiful subjects for my ballads. I will find some rhymes and compose a ballad about it.

翻译：我就能得到一些适合写进歌谣的好题材。我要找些韵脚，为它创作一首歌谣。

Context: Dandelion spat out a pip and threw the apple core at a patched mongrel.

翻译：丹德里恩吐出一颗苹果籽，把苹果核扔向一只花斑杂种狗。

- subject：创作题材；ballad /'bæl.əd/：叙事歌谣。
- rhyme /raɪm/：韵、押韵词，h 不发音；compose：创作。
- spat：spit 的过去式；pip：水果籽；apple core：苹果核。
- patched mongrel：花斑混种狗；现代更中性地说 mixed-breed dog。
- 现代口语：That would give me some great material for my songs. / I could write a song about it.
- 现代书面：The adventure would provide excellent subject matter for a ballad.

10. Monster、monstrosity、riddled with arrows

Context: monsters / monstrosities / riddled with arrows

翻译：怪物。/ 畸形怪物或丑陋怪诞之物。/ 身中许多箭，被射得千疮百孔。

- monster：普通意义上的怪物，也可比喻残忍的人。
- monstrosity：强调某物畸形、怪异或丑陋得令人震惊。
- be riddled with...：布满……、充斥着……，暗示数量很多。
- 现代口语：The creature was covered in arrow wounds. / He was hit by an arrow.
- 现代书面：The monster was riddled with arrows. / The plan was riddled with errors.

11. 湿地、水鸟与桤木

Context: dykes and ponds hidden by alder trees and filled with quacking mallards, garganeys, herons and grebes

翻译：桤木掩映着沟渠和池塘，水面上满是嘎嘎鸣叫的绿头鸭、白眉鸭，以及苍鹭和□□。

- dyke / dike：堤坝、沟渠或堤岸水道；这里可理解为沟渠。
- alder tree：桤木；be filled with...：充满……。
- mallard：绿头鸭；garganey：白眉鸭；heron：苍鹭；grebe：□□。
- 现代口语：The ponds were hidden by trees and full of waterbirds.
- 现代书面：Alder trees concealed the channels and ponds, which teemed with waterbirds.

12. Scoff 与 growl

Context: scoff / growl

翻译：不屑地嘲讽。/ 低沉而愤怒地说；动物低吼。

- scoff 强调轻蔑、不相信的态度；常用 scoff at…。
- growl 强调低沉、粗哑、愤怒或威胁的声音。
- 现代例句：“You call that a plan?” he scoffed.
- 现代例句：“Get out,” he growled.

13. Sharp wit 与 dread to think

Context: The closer we get to the edge of the world, the sharper your wit. I dread to think what it will come to.

翻译：我们越接近世界尽头，你的嘴就越厉害。我都不敢想象这样下去最后会变成什么样。

- the + 比较级, the + 比较级：越……，就越……。
- sharp wit：敏锐、犀利的机智；witty：机智幽默的。
- 第一句省略了 becomes：the sharper your wit becomes。
- dread to think...：不敢想象……；come to：最终发展成某种结果。
- 现代口语：The closer we get, the wittier you become. I hate to think where this is going.
- 现代书面：I dread to think what it may eventually lead to.

14. 缰绳、母马、荨麻

Context: Geralt let go of the reins and let his mare snort at the roadside nettles.

翻译：杰洛特松开缰绳，任由母马凑到路边的荨麻旁喷着鼻息。

- let go of...：松开……；reins：缰绳，通常用复数。
- let + 人或动物 + 动词原形：让某人或动物做某事。
- mare：母马；snort：从鼻中用力喷气、打响鼻。
- nettle：荨麻；roadside：路边的。
- 现代口语：He loosened the reins and let the horse sniff around.

15. Plank、催马与哐啷行驶

Context: sit on the plank / Nettly clucked his tongue at the horses, and the vehicle clattered along the beam-reinforced dyke.

翻译：坐在木板座上。/ 内特利用舌头发出催马声，马车沿着用木梁加固的堤道哐啷前行。

- plank：长而厚的木板；在车上可译为木板座或板凳。
- cluck one's tongue at the horses：用舌头发出短促的催马声。
- clatter along：哐啷哐啷地前行。
- beam-reinforced dyke：用木梁加固的堤道；reinforce 是“加固”，与 rein（缰绳）无关。
- 现代口语：He clicked his tongue to urge the horses forward. The cart rattled down the road.
- 现代书面：The wagon clattered along the timber-reinforced embankment.

16. Cart、wagon 与 folding wagon

Context: cart / wagon / folding wagon

翻译：较小、较轻的车或手推车。/ 较大、较重的四轮车。/ 四周有布围、可折叠的拖车。

- shopping cart (美) / shopping trolley (英)：购物车。
- platform cart / flatbed cart：平板推车。
- folding wagon / collapsible wagon：可折叠拖车。
- covered wagon：有篷马车。
- 现代例句：We use a folding wagon to carry groceries from the car.

17. 金色黑麦与高大的庄稼

Context: Rye like gold, and a mounted peasant could hide in that corn. Or that oilseed--look, how enormous.

翻译：黑麦像黄金一样灿烂；庄稼高得连骑在马上的农民都能藏进去。再看那些油料作物--长得多么高大！

- rye：黑麦；mounted peasant：骑着马的农民。
- corn：这里是英式用法，泛指谷物或庄稼，不特指玉米。
- oilseed：油料作物；enormous：巨大的、异常高大的。
- A mounted peasant could hide... 是夸张说法，强调作物高而茂盛。
- 现代口语：The rye is golden, and the crops are incredibly tall.
- 现代书面：The golden rye stood tall enough to conceal a mounted rider.

18. Lupin、vetch 与旺盛生长

Context: "Look at those purple flowers. They're lupins." "They's be vetch, to be true," interrupted Nettly. "Everything seeds mightily here, and grows as to make the heart sing."

翻译：“看那些紫花，那是羽扇豆。”“其实是野豌豆。”内特利打断道。“这里什么植物都结籽繁盛，长得让人看了心里高兴。”

- lupin /'luː.pɪn/：羽扇豆、鲁冰花，通常有直立花穗。
- vetch /vetʃ/：野豌豆、巢菜，常蔓生或借卷须攀爬。
- seed 作动词：结籽、繁殖；mightily：非常旺盛地。
- make the heart sing：让人由衷高兴。
- They's be... 是刻意模仿的乡村方言；标准英语为 They are...。
- 现代口语：Those are actually vetch, not lupins. Everything grows incredibly well here.
- 现代书面：The fertile soil allows every crop to flourish.

19. 祖先定居并赶走精灵

Context: That be why our forefathers settled here, first ridding the land of the elves.

翻译：所以我们的祖先才在这里定居；他们首先把精灵从这片土地上赶走了。

- That be why...：方言，相当于 That is why...
- forefathers：祖先、先辈；settle somewhere：在某地定居。
- rid A of B：从 A 中清除 B；first ridding... 补充说明先做了什么。
- rid 把精灵说成需要“清除”的麻烦，也暗示人类占领土地、驱逐精灵的冲突。
- 现代口语：That's why our ancestors settled here after driving out the elves.
- 现代书面：Our forefathers settled here, having first driven the elves from the land.

20. Nudge、地名与相处关系

Context: Dandelion nudged the witcher with his elbow. "You paying attention? The elves have gone, but their name remains. Lack of imagination."

翻译：丹德里恩用手肘轻碰了猎魔人一下。“你在听吗？精灵已经走了，但他们取的地名仍然保留着。真没想象力。”

- nudge someone with one's elbow：用手肘轻碰某人，以提醒或暗示。
- You paying attention?：口语省略，完整形式是 Are you paying attention?
- their name remains：这里指精灵取的地名 Dol Blathanna 仍被沿用。
- Lack of imagination.：省略句，相当于 That shows a lack of imagination.
- 现代口语：Are you listening? Not very imaginative, is it?
- 现代书面：Although the elves are gone, the name they gave the valley survives.

21. 与精灵互不来往

Context: "How do you get on with the elves here, dear host? You've got them in the mountains across the path, after all." "We nae mix with each other. Each to his own."

翻译：“主人，你们和这里的精灵相处得怎么样？毕竟小路另一边的山区里就住着他们。”“我们互不来往，各过各的。”

- get on with someone：与某人相处；美式英语也常说 get along with。
- you've got them...：你们这里有他们，不是“你拥有他们”。
- after all：毕竟，用来补充理由。
- nae：方言中的 not / no；We nae mix = We don't mix。
- Each to his own：这里指各过各的；现代中性形式是 Each to their own。
- 现代口语：We don't have much to do with each other. We keep to ourselves.
- 更自然：We leave them alone, and they leave us alone. / Live and let live.
- 现代书面：The two communities maintain little contact and largely keep to themselves.

快速复习

表达	中文	现代常用替换
furrow one's brow	皱起眉头	frown
break out in spots	起斑点、起疹子	break out in a rash
in a drunken stupor	烂醉得神志不清	too drunk to...
tamper with...	对.....做手脚	同样常用
nod with feigned interest	假装感兴趣地点头	pretend to be interested
be riddled with...	布满、充斥着	be full of...
dread to think...	不敢想象.....	hate to think...
clatter along	哐啷前行	rattle along
make the heart sing	让人由衷高兴	be a joy to see
rid A of B	从 A 中清除 B	remove / drive B from A
get on with someone	与某人相处	get along with someone
keep to oneself	各过各的、少与人来往	同样常用